AI Bootcamp — Week 1: Foundations

Friday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 1, the candidate can:

- Explain the Prompt/Harness/Model framework and why the harness, not the model, controls what a skill can do
- Apply the EDD (Evaluation-Driven Development) discipline: write Evaluation Criteria (EC) and manual test cases before building any skill
- Explain and apply the RTCC prompt structure (Role = WHO, Task = WHAT, Context = WHY, Constraints = HOW) to a real skill
- Build four sequential content creation skills as durable, committed `.skill.md` files
- Direct an AI to write a Python evaluation script (deterministic checks plus an LLM judge) and interpret its results
- Verify that every instruction in a skill is load-bearing using manual tests and evaluation runs
- Produce a working end-to-end content pipeline: Trend Identification → Ideation → Development → Graphics

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TIMING

- **Monday:** 1:00 PM – 5:00 PM (travel morning, 4 hours)
- **Tuesday–Thursday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each)
- **Friday:** 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM (travel afternoon, 3 hours)

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FRIDAY (9:00 AM – 12:00 PM): GRAPHICS SKILL AND PIPELINE COMPLETION

9:00 – 10:00 AM — EDD FIRST: WRITE THE GRAPHICS TEST FILE

Skill 4: Graphics:

- **Input:** A completed `post.md`
- **Output file:** `graphics.md` : 3 to 5 fully formed image generation prompts suitable for Midjourney, DALL-E, or equivalent
- **Required output elements per prompt:** Subject description, visual style/aesthetic, color palette notes, mood/tone, composition guidance, aspect ratio recommendation for the target platform, negative prompt suggestions (what to exclude)

Write your test file. For "good" image generation prompts, the EC should be objective enough to evaluate without running the prompt through an image generator. Think: would a designer reading this prompt know exactly what to produce?

10:00 – 11:00 AM — BUILD, EVALUATE, AND LOAD-BEARING AUDIT

Build the Graphics skill. Have the AI generate the evaluation script. Run the full EDD cycle. Perform the load-bearing audit before declaring done.

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM — FULL PIPELINE RUN AND WEEK 1 WRAP

Run the complete four-skill pipeline from a single topic input to a complete `graphics.md`. Review all four output files for quality and coherence.

Week 1 Artifacts Review:

- [ ] `trend-identification` skill (RTCC, committed `.skill.md` with `disable-model-invocation: true`, all instructions load-bearing)
- [ ] `ideation` skill (same standard)
- [ ] `development` skill (same standard)
- [ ] `graphics` skill (same standard)
- [ ] Manual test files (EC) for at least Trend Identification (hand-written, pre-build)
- [ ] Python evaluation scripts and run results for all four skills (deterministic checks plus LLM judge)
- [ ] Load-bearing audit documentation for at least two skills

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WEEK 1 DELIVERABLES (COMMITTED TO REPO)

- [ ] Four RTCC skill files (one per pipeline stage), all durable `.skill.md` files with `disable-model-invocation: true`
- [ ] Manual test file for Trend Identification, written before the skill was built
- [ ] Python evaluation scripts and baseline + iteration results for all four skills
- [ ] Load-bearing audit notes: flagged instructions, removed instructions, confirmed failures
- [ ] Sample pipeline run: `trends.md` → `ideas.md` → `post.md` → `graphics.md` (one complete run, committed)

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